

Skills Summary

Ordering Three Amounts: Least to Greatest

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Ordering three numbers

The rule:

Least means the smallest amount. **Greatest** means the largest amount. When you count up, you say the least number *first* and the greatest number *last*.

- Find the least of the three. Write it in the first blank.
- Of the two that are left, find the least. Write it in the middle blank.
- The last one goes in the third blank.

Example: Put 8, 3 and 6 in order from least to greatest.

Step 1. These are three plain numbers, so use counting order: whichever is said first when counting up is the least.

Step 2. Count up: 3 comes first, then 6, then 8. So the order is **3, 6, 8**.

Try it: Put 5, 9 and 2 in order from least to greatest.

check: 2, 5, 9

Skill 2 — Count each group, then order

The rule:

When the amounts are shown as pictures (dots, ten-frames, cube trains), you cannot compare them until every group has a *number*. Count each group, write its number next to the picture, and only then put the numbers in order. A full ten-frame is 10; count on from 10 for the extra counters.

Example: One full ten-frame and 3 extra counters; a group of 6; a full ten-frame.

Step 1. Nothing can be ordered yet — turn each picture into a number first.

Step 2. Full frame and 3 more: count on 11, 12, 13. The others are 6 and 10. In counting order: **6, 10, 13**.

Try it: One full ten-frame and 2 extra counters; a group of 5; a group of 8.

check: 5, 8, 12

Skill 3 — Work it out, then order

The rule:

Sometimes one amount is hidden in the story: “3 more than” or “scored 5 more points”. Do that addition **first**, so you have three real numbers, and then order them. Never order the numbers the story happens to say — order the amounts each person really has.

Example: Ana has 4 shells and finds 3 more. Ben has 5 shells. Cal has 9 shells.

Step 1. Ana's amount is hidden, so work out Ana's total before comparing anybody.

Step 2. Ana has $4 + 3 = 7$ shells. Now order 7, 5 and 9: **5, 7, 9**.

Try it: Ana has 6 marbles and gets 2 more. Ben has 4 marbles. Cal has 10 marbles.

check: **4, 8, 10**

(!) Watch out: 14 and 41 use the same two digits but they are not the same amount. Look at the **tens** digit first: 14 has 1 ten, 41 has 4 tens, so 14 is the smaller number.